UNGRADED PRACTICE

STAR(T) Practice: Professionalism

A story about following through, owning a mistake, or being someone others could count on.

Professionalism is about how you show up: following through, taking responsibility, managing your time and commitments, acting ethically, and communicating with care. Think of a moment when you showed reliability, integrity, or accountability in a real situation.

This is practice, and it isn't graded. Draft your story here, then record it or copy it into the matching STAR(T) Stories portal in Blackboard.

Two ways to use this handout. It matches the Professionalism Practice Guide in the STAR(T) Stories Guide. Print it and fill it in by hand, or type in the boxes below and save a PDF. Aim for a story that runs 2 to 4 minutes out loud.

NAME _____ **DATE** _____

STEP 0

Find your story first

Your story can come from school, work, family, or your community. It doesn't have to be dramatic. It has to be real, and yours.

- Was there a time you met a deadline or commitment even when it was hard?
- Have you ever owned a mistake, taken responsibility for something that went wrong, and handled it well?
- Is there a moment when you juggled competing responsibilities and made deliberate choices about priorities?
- Was there a time when doing the right thing was harder than taking the easy way out?

The experience I'm going to use

S — Situation

Set the scene. What was going on?

> Give just enough context for someone who wasn't there. Two or three sentences is usually plenty.

Watch out: The Situation is the setup, not the story. Get to the Task quickly.

T — Task

Define your role. What was yours to do?

> What were you accountable for? What was expected of you, and what made it hard to meet?

Watch out: Your Task is what you were responsible for, not the group's general goal.

A — Action

Show what you did, step by step.

> This is the most important step. Use "I": I decided, I reached out, I chose. Show the specific choices you made, especially when the easier choice would have been to do less, avoid the conversation, or let it slide. Describe what you actually did, not what you were supposed to do.

Watch out: "We figured it out" hides your part. Describe what you did, even inside a group effort.

R Result

Name the outcome. What happened because of what you did?

> Results for this skill often show up in relationships: trust built, a problem solved, a standard kept. They don't have to be dramatic to matter.

Watch out: "It went well" isn't a result. Name what specifically happened.

T Transfer

Connect it forward. What does this mean for what comes next?

> How will this shape the way you show up at work or in your program? Name a field, a role, or a situation where this skill will be tested.

Watch out: "This will help me in the future" isn't a Transfer. Name a specific place, role, or situation.

AFTER YOU DRAFT IT

Quick reflection

Which step was hardest to write, and why do you think that is?

Does anything sound generic, like anyone could have written it? Where could you be more specific?